

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 5
♥ A 9
♦ A 10 7 3
♣ K Q 9 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q 10 8 7 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 5



♠ Q J 4 2
♥ 6
♦ K Q J 5
♣ J 10 6 2

♠ A K 7 6

♥ J 5 3

♦ 9 4

♣ A 8 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

No matter how much we try to reduce bridge to rules and guidelines we will never get rid of the judgement factor. With this hand you definitely have 3 fast tricks for partner. In theory he can take 6 of his own, so 3♥ should be the right contract. BUT, maybe he could ruff a ♦ in your dummy?

Fortune favors the bold so you bid 4♥ . . . and live happily ever after.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 4
 ♥ Q 8 6
 ♦ A 9 6 3
 ♣ J 6 4 2

♠ 6
 ♥ A K J 10 5 4
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ A K Q 5

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W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 5 2
 ♥ 9
 ♦ 5 2
 ♣ 8 7

♠ A 3
 ♥ 7 3 2
 ♦ Q J 10 8 4
 ♣ 10 9 3

West	North	East	South
		4♠	

All Pass

4♠ by East
 partner for the ♥Q they can make slam.

This is what preempting is all about.

You dealt this hand.

With 7 estimated winners and an 8-card suit you preempt 4♠. And you are not going to make it. In fact you are only going to make 8 tricks so you will go down 2.

You may be wishing that you had opened just 3♠, rather than following the guidelines and opening at the 4-level. The problem with that thinking is that the lower your preempt, the less difficult it is for the opponent's to enter the bidding. If you had opened 3♠ South might have been able to make a Takeout Double and they could have found their ♥ fit. Just visualize their combined hands; they have 9 ♥s between them, they have no ♠ losers, no ♣ losers and just one ♦ loser. If they decide to finesse your

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 2
 ♥ J 9 4 2
 ♦ J 7 5
 ♣ J 10 5 2

♠ 10 6

♥ A K Q 8 5

♦ A K

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ 5 4

♥ 10 7 3

♦ Q 10 6 3

♣ K Q 9 3

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 3

♥ 6

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ 7

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

If is hard to imagine any hand partner could have where the slam wouldn't be there. Maybe you should use Blackwood, just to be sure? If partner shows 1 Ace you would then bid 6 ♠. And if he shows no Aces you would then . . . bid 6 ♠ anyway. So you leave out the middle step and bid 6 ♠.

Did you think about bidding 6NT instead? Ugh, they would have led a ♣.